

SOP-OPS-001 Hot Work Permit Procedure

Revision D · Owner: Technical Services · Classification: Internal

1. When a hot work permit is required

Any work that produces flame, sparks or heat able to ignite flammable material: welding, grinding, cutting, and the use of non-intrinsically-safe electrical equipment within a hazardous area.

2. Gas testing

Before issue, the area shall be gas tested. The lower explosive limit (LEL) reading shall be 0 percent at the work point and below 10 percent LEL within 15 metres. Oxygen shall be between 19.5 and 23.5 percent by volume. Re-test every 2 hours and after any break longer than 30 minutes.

3. Isolation

Lines within 15 metres shall be isolated, drained and blinded or confirmed free of hydrocarbons. Open drains and sewers within 15 metres shall be covered.

4. Fire watch

A trained fire watch with a charged extinguisher shall remain at the site during the work and for 30 minutes after completion.

5. Validity

A hot work permit is valid for one shift, maximum 8 hours, and must be revalidated by the area authority at shift change.